

present continuous, against the present simple · 22 words for jobs and workplaces · *a* and *an* with job names · the short forms of *be* · the long *er* sound

◆ A • THE WORLD

Four workplaces at the same minute,
and what is actually happening in
them

◆ C • THE PERFORMANCE

You interview somebody about their
job and report what they really do

0A • Find it — fourteen things

Find these in the picture. Write the number.

☐ a kitchen ☐ an office ☐ a hospital ☐ a factory ☐ a uniform ☐ a customer ☐ a machine ☐ a
phone ☐ a floor ☐ a coffee ☐ a clock ☐ a door ☐ a box ☐ a chair

Three of these words are not in the picture. Which three?

a shift • a team • a manager

0B • Guess it

Look at the four people in a uniform. **Which of them has the most difficult job?** Say one thing.
You can use these words:

work • uniform • customer • clean • phone

0C • Say it

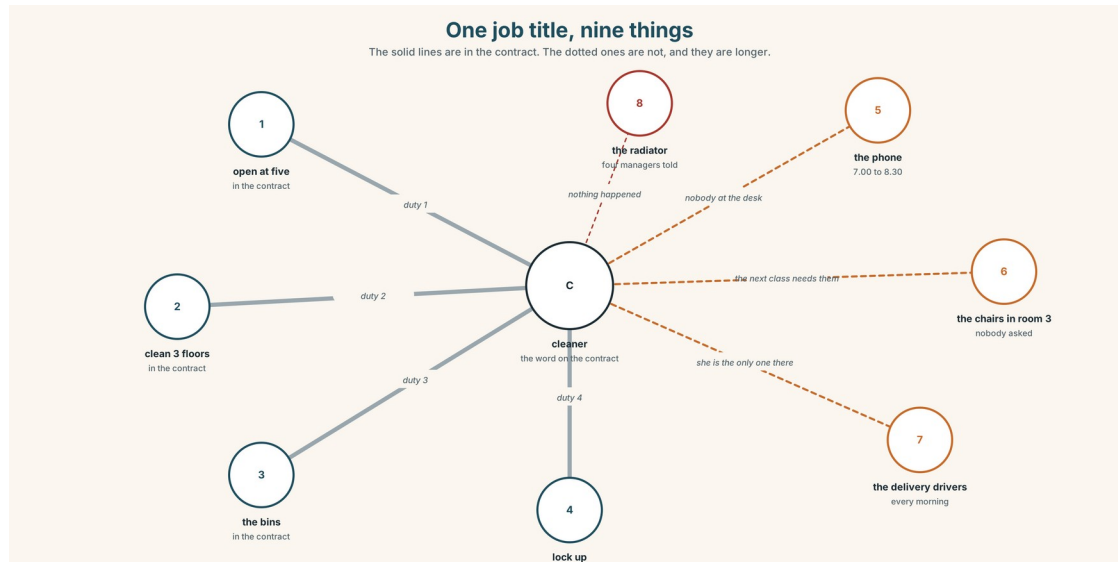
Record. Thirty seconds. Do not prepare.

What are you doing right now, and what do you usually do at this hour?

You will listen to this again on the last page.

Part 1 • Vocabulary Lab 1 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

1A • Meet — the job, and the work



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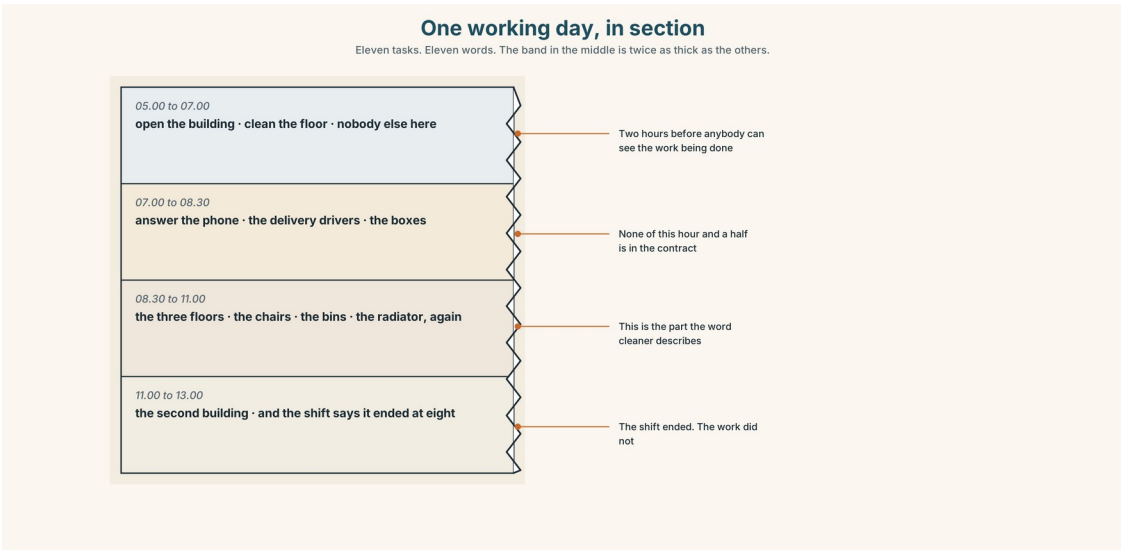
One job title, nine things — The solid lines are in the contract. The dotted ones are not, and they are longer.

job	The word on the contract.
shift	The hours. Not the same thing as the job.
team	The people. Also not the same thing as the job.
uniform	What makes strangers treat you differently.
customer	The person who decides whether the job was done.
manager	The person who decides whether it was done well.

1B • Meet — the words

job • team • office • factory • kitchen • hospital • school • nurse • driver • waiter • cook • cleaner • engineer • manager • uniform • shift • customer

Write each word under the right picture.



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One working day, in section — Eleven tasks. Eleven words. The band in the middle is twice as thick as the others.

1C • Sort — a person, or a place?

Put each word in the right box. **Two of them can go in both. Which, and why?**

nurse · kitchen · driver · office · cook · hospital · cleaner · factory · manager · school

A PERSON	A PLACE	BOTH
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1D • What people actually do all day

answer the phone	Eleven times an hour, and none of it is in the job description.
serve customers	The visible part. About a quarter of the time.
clean the floor	Twice a day, and everybody notices only when it is not done.
make coffee	Forty times a morning in a café. Twice a morning in an office, and it is somebody's unpaid job.
fix a machine	Four minutes, if you know which machine. Forty, if you do not.
look after	The widest verb on this page. It covers people, machines and buildings.

Now say them. Five of these six have an object after them. **Which one changes its meaning completely if you take the little word away?**

1E • Stretch — the phrases you will need today

work in a... · start work · finish work · take a break · What do you do?

Match each phrase to the moment you need it.

1. Somebody at a party asks about your life. → _____
2. You are telling somebody where you spend your mornings. → _____
3. It is twenty past eleven and you have been standing since six. → _____
4. The shift begins. → _____
5. The shift ends, and the shift ending is not the same as the work ending. → _____

1F • The hard one

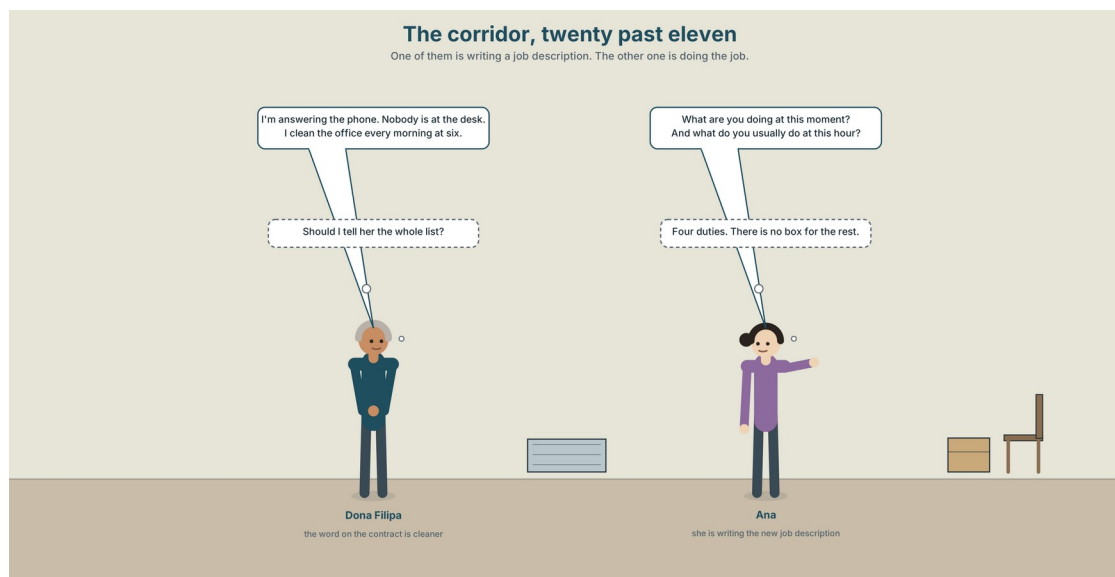
f I'm on my break.

Practise it three times. **Four words that stop a conversation politely, and almost nobody at A1 knows them.**

1G • Own it

Write down one job you would like and one job you would be good at. Do not write your name. The class guesses whose card it is. **They are often not the same job.**

Part 2 • Listening ♦ A • THE WORLD



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The corridor, twenty past eleven — One of them is writing a job description. The other one is doing the job.

2A • Twenty past eleven 📞 Track 8.1

Before you listen. Ana is writing a new job description for the cleaner. **Guess: how many things will Dona Filipa say she does?**

Listen once. One question. What is Dona Filipa doing at this moment?

Listen again. Complete the table.

Right now

Usually, at this hour

Dona Filipa

Ana

Marco

Listen again. True or false?

1. Dona Filipa is cleaning the floor right now. ☐ T ☐ F
2. She usually answers the phone in the morning. ☐ T ☐ F
3. Ana is writing the job description now. ☐ T ☐ F
4. Dona Filipa works in a hospital as well. ☐ T ☐ F

Noticing. Four sentences from the recording.

1. *I'm cleaning the office.*
2. *I clean the office every morning.*
3. *She's answering the phone.*
4. *She answers the phone about eleven times an hour.*

Two are about right now and two are about every day. How can you tell, in the first two words?

2B • Decoding clinic **Track 8.2**

Twenty seconds of Dona Filipa at speed. Three jobs.

1. Count how many *-ing* verbs you hear.
2. *I'm* and *she's* are very short. How many sounds are in each?
3. She says *work* and *worker* and *working*. Which one has the longest vowel?

Transcripts, page 154.

Part 3 • Grammar Lab 1 **B • THE SYSTEM**

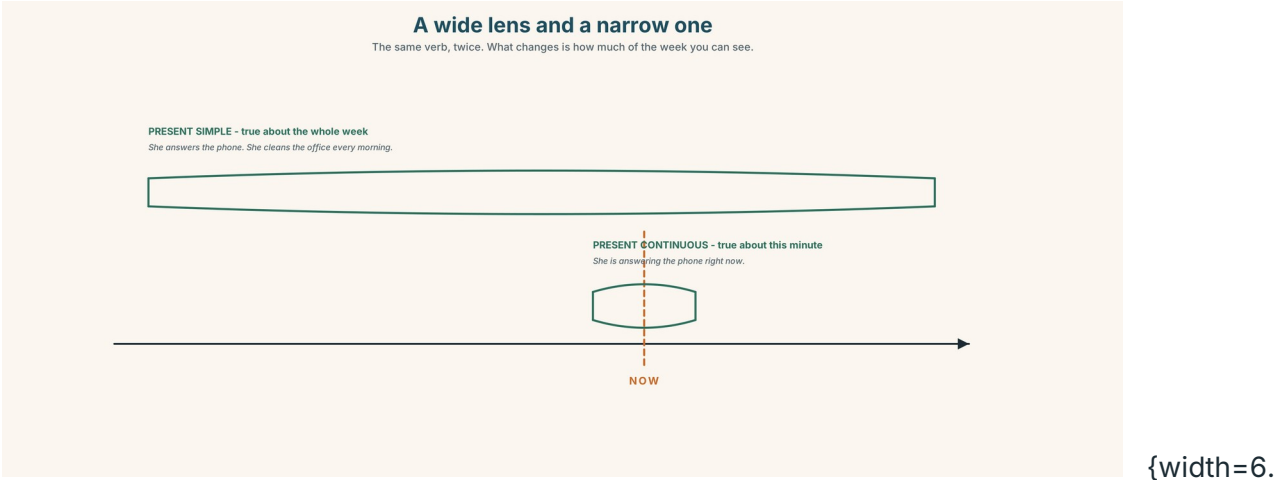
Right now, and every day

3A • Notice

Look at the four sentences in Part 2 again.

1. Which two words make the *right now* form?
2. What is on the end of the verb in those two?
3. In the *every day* sentences, is there a form of *be*?
4. Which pair would you use to describe a photograph?

3B • See



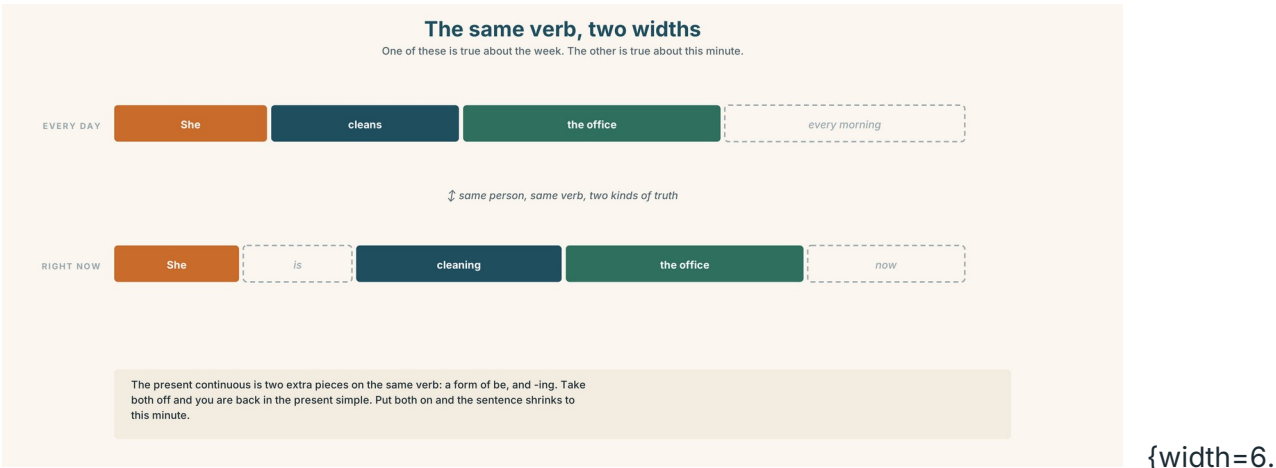
6in}

A wide lens and a narrow one — The same verb, twice. What changes is how much of the week you can see.

3C • Know

right now	am / is / are + -ing	<i>I'm cleaning the office. She's answering the phone.</i>
every day	the plain verb (+ s)	<i>I clean the office every morning. She answers the phone.</i>
negative	am not / isn't / aren't + -ing	<i>He isn't working today.</i>
question	be to the front	<i>What are you doing? Is she working?</i>

Two tenses, two kinds of truth. *She answers the phone* is true about her job. *She's answering the phone* is true about this second. Both can be true at once, and both can be false at once.



6in}

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The same verb, two widths — One of these is true about the week. The other is true about this minute.

a / an with jobs

She's a nurse. He's an engineer. I'm a cleaner.

never without it

She's nurse is not English. Every job takes a or an.

an before a vowel sound

an engineer · an artist · an office worker

Why it matters. This is how you describe a photograph, a video, a street, a room, or anything at all that is happening while you are speaking.

3D • Use — controlled

Complete with the present simple or the present continuous.

Dona Filipa (1) _____ (clean) the office every morning. Right now she (2) _____ (answer) the phone, because Ana is not at the desk. Marco (3) _____ (make) about forty coffees every morning. At this moment he (4) _____ (sit) down, and he (5) _____ (not work). What (6) _____ you _____ (do)?

3E • Use — guided

Change each sentence from *every day* to *right now*.

1. She cleans the floor.
2. He makes coffee.
3. They serve customers.
4. I answer the phone.
5. We fix the machine.

3F • Use — open

In pairs. Describe a photograph on your phone without showing it. Your partner asks five questions. **Every question must be in the present continuous.**

3G • Check — six items, mark your own

1. She _____ (clean) the office at this moment.
2. He _____ (start) work at six every day.
3. They _____ (not work) today.
4. What _____ you _____ (do) right now?
5. × *She is nurse.* → correct it.
6. × *I am work at the moment.* → correct it.

The job name standing bare

×

She is nurse.

nurse - with nothing in front of it

is

In English a job name is a group you belong to, not a title you hold. Without the small word in front, the sentence sounds as though nurse were her name, or a rank like Captain. Many languages need no article here, which is why this error survives for years.

✓

She is a nurse.

a - one of a large group

is

The a says one of many. It is the same a as in a desk and a pen, and it is required with every job name in the singular: a cook, a driver, a manager, an engineer. Only in the plural does it go. They are nurses.

What the writer thought:

The word feels like a title, and titles in English do go bare - she is Head of Year, he is Captain. Jobs are not titles. If ten people in the building could truthfully say it, it needs a or an.

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The job name standing bare — The job name standing bare

0-3 → Workbook pp. 32-35. **4-5** → Part 6. **6** → page 178.

Part 4 • Speaking ◆ **C • THE PERFORMANCE**

4A • Fluency starter — what am I doing?

One person mimes. The class asks *Are you...?* questions. **Only present continuous questions are allowed, and only ten of them.**

4B • The functional core — talking about work

The same job, described twice
On the left, the contract. On the right, one hour of a Tuesday morning.

the contract

CLEANER • 05.00-08.00 • four duties

one hour of a Tuesday

phone x11 • 2 drivers • chairs in room 3 • the radiator

Find the six. One of the two would let you do the job tomorrow. Which, and what is in it that is not in the other?

6 differences — find them all

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The same job, described twice — On the left, the contract. On the right, one hour of a Tuesday morning.

Language Bank

asking	<i>What do you do? · Where do you work? · What are you doing now?</i>
the title	<i>I'm a cook. I'm an engineer. I work in a hospital.</i>
the hours	<i>I start work at six. I finish work at three. I'm on my break.</i>
the reality	<i>I usually... but today I'm...</i>

Information gap. Learner A has four job titles. Learner B has four lists of what those people actually did yesterday. **Match them, and find the one that cannot be matched.**

4C • The performance — the job interview, reversed

Interview a classmate about a job somebody in their family does. **Three minutes.** You must ask:

what they do · where they work · what they are doing at this moment, probably · one thing they do that is not in the job title

Report in three sentences. **Record it.**

4D • Observer

One person listens for **one thing**: did anybody say a job name without *a* or *an*?

4E • Two criteria

☐ Did I use both tenses, and for the right kind of truth? ☐ Did I find one thing that is not in the job title?

Part 5 • Reading A • THE WORLD

5A • Predict

The title is "**Nine things, and four of them are in the contract.**" **Whose job do you think this is?**

5B • Read — sixty seconds

Nine things, and four of them are in the contract

Dona Filipa is a cleaner. That is the word on her contract and it is the word she uses when somebody asks.

Here is her morning. She opens the building at five. She cleans the three floors. She puts the chairs back in room 3, which nobody asks her to do. She answers the phone between seven and half past eight, because there is nobody at the desk. She tells the delivery drivers where to leave the boxes. She knows which radiator does not work and she has told four managers.

At twenty past eleven she is standing in the corridor answering the phone, and a visitor walks past her without seeing her, because she is wearing a uniform and the visitor is looking for somebody in an office.

Four of those nine things are in her contract. The school would stop working on a Tuesday if she did only those four.

5C • Answer

1. What is the word on her contract?
2. What time does she open the building?
3. Why does she answer the phone?
4. How many of the nine things are in her contract?
5. **Why does the visitor not see her?**
6. **The last line says the school would stop working. Which of the five extra things do you think matters most, and why?**

5D • Vocabulary in context

Guess from the text. Then check.

the word on her contract · nobody asks her to · without seeing her · looking for somebody · would stop working

5E • The counter-text

The job description, in draft
Four numbered duties, and one line at the bottom that does all the work.

ESCOLA MONTE - JOB DESCRIPTION - DRAFT 2		
Title	CLEANER	
Hours	05.00 - 08.00	
Days	Monday to Saturday	
Hours a week	18	
DUTIES		
NO.	DUTY	HOW OFTEN
1	OPEN THE BUILDING	daily
2	CLEAN THREE FLOORS	daily
3	EMPTY THE BINS	daily
4	LOCK THE BACK DOOR	daily
AND THE LAST LINE: "and other duties as required". Five words. They cover answering the phone for ninety minutes a day, meeting the delivery drivers, putting the chairs back in room 3, and knowing which radiator does not work.		
In the margin, in pencil, a second list has been started and the first two items crossed out.		

Three hours a day on paper

Eighteen hours a week. She is in the building for about thirty

Four duties, all of them things you can see when they are not done

Five words that are doing more work than the four duties above them

Somebody started to fix this and stopped after two lines

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The job description, in draft — Four numbered duties, and one line at the bottom that does all the work.

Read the job description and answer.

1. What is the job title?
2. **What hours is the shift, and how many hours is that a week?**
3. How many duties are listed?
4. **What does *and other duties as required* mean, and who decides what they are?**

5F • Two texts

The job description lists four duties. The reading lists nine things she does.

Which document is more useful to the school, and which is more useful to Dona Filipa? Say one sentence.

Part 6 • Vocabulary Lab 2 ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

Job names, and the small word in front

What do you do?
One person, six answers, at the same party, one hour later each time.

1  1 "A cleaner."

2  2 "I'm a cleaner."

3  3 "I work in a school."

4  4 "I start at five."

5  5 "I open the building."

6  6 "I am the first person there."

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What do you do? — One person, six answers, at the same party, one hour later each time.

6A • The ones that catch everybody

a doctor	never <i>I am doctor</i>
an engineer	<i>an</i> , because of the sound at the start, not the letter
an artist	same reason
a nurse	<i>a</i> , because <i>n</i> is a consonant sound

6B • Say them

a doctor • an engineer • an artist • a nurse • a waiter • a cleaner • a manager

6C • Chunk

1. I _____ **in a** hospital.
2. I _____ **work** at six.
3. I _____ **work** at three.
4. I need to **take a** _____ .

5. _____ do you do?
6. I'm on my _____.

6D • Contrast Clinic

Six items. Present **simple** or present **continuous**?

1. She _____ the floor every evening. (*clean*)
2. Look — she _____ the floor now. (*clean*)
3. He _____ coffee about forty times a morning. (*make*)
4. He _____ coffee at this moment. (*make*)
5. They _____ customers all day on Saturday. (*serve*)
6. Listen — somebody _____ the phone. (*answer*)

Part 7 • Pronunciation & Fluency Lab ♦ B • THE SYSTEM

The long *er*, and the words that shrink

The words that shrink

Written at full length above, said at half length below. The shaded letters are not heard.

I am working	→	Im working	two words, one beat
she is working	→	sheez working	is becomes a z on the end of she
they are working	→	their working	are disappears into one r
what are you doing	→	whatch doo in	four words, two beats, no g at the

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6in}

The words that shrink — Written at full length above, said at half length below. The shaded letters are not heard.

7A • Hear

/ɜ:/ long, and the mouth is almost closed: *work · nurse · her · first · shirt* **the short forms:** *I'm · she's · he's · they're · we're · isn't · aren't*

7B • Say

Say each group three times. Then say this:

She's a nurse and she's working. — two short forms and the long *er*, twice.

7C • Make it mean something

Say these two:

She is a nurse. — four words, four beats, and it sounds like a correction *She's a nurse.* — three beats, and it sounds like ordinary speech

The full form is not more polite. It is more emphatic. Which one would you say to a friend?

7D • Fluency 20

Twenty seconds: **six things people in this building are doing right now.** Three times, faster.

Part 8 • Writing C • THE PERFORMANCE

What somebody really does • 40–60 words

8A • Read the model

My aunt is a nurse. She works in a hospital in Porto. [the title and the place, first]

She starts work at seven and finishes at seven. Three days, then four days off. [the hours, and the shift pattern, which the title does not tell you]

She says the job is mostly talking. She answers questions from families all day. [what it actually is]

Right now she is probably asleep. It is four o'clock in the afternoon. [one sentence in the other tense, at the end]

Questions about the writer's choices:

1. The hours come second, before the work. **Why are the hours that important?**
2. *mostly talking*. **Why is that more informative than a list of duties?**
3. The last sentence is a guess. **Why end with something the writer does not know?**

8B • The anti-model

My aunt is a nurse. She works in a hospital. It is a difficult job. She helps people. She is very tired.

Correct English, and it is every nurse who has ever lived. **Add the hours, one real task, and one sentence about right now.**

8C • Plan

title and place → hours and pattern → what it actually is → one sentence about now

8D • Write — 40 to 60 words

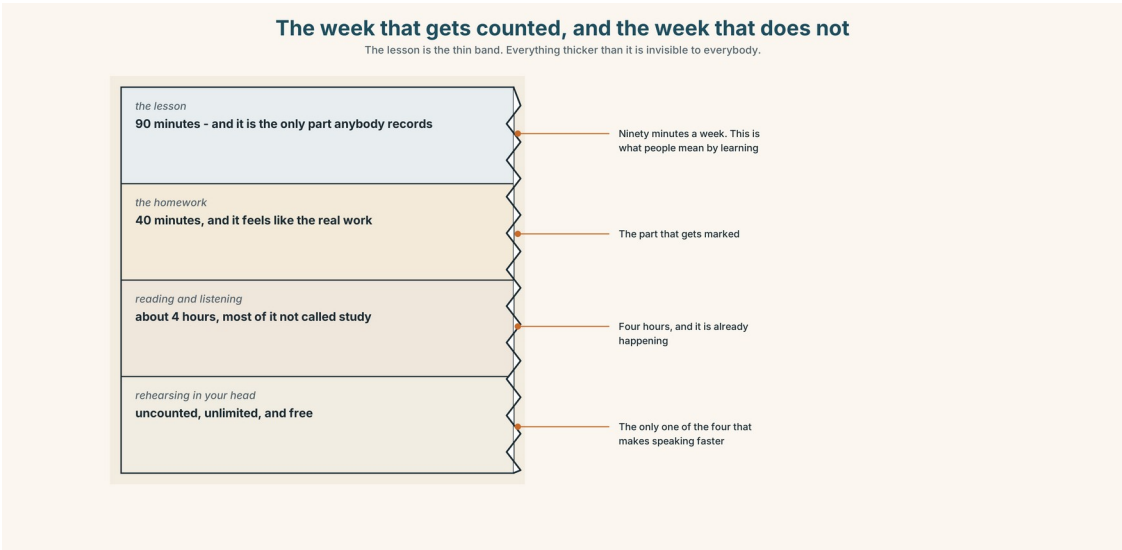
8E • Peer review — two things only

☐ Is there one sentence in the present continuous? ☐ Is there one thing in it that is not in the job title?

8F • Publish

On the wall, with no names. **The class matches the description to the job title.**

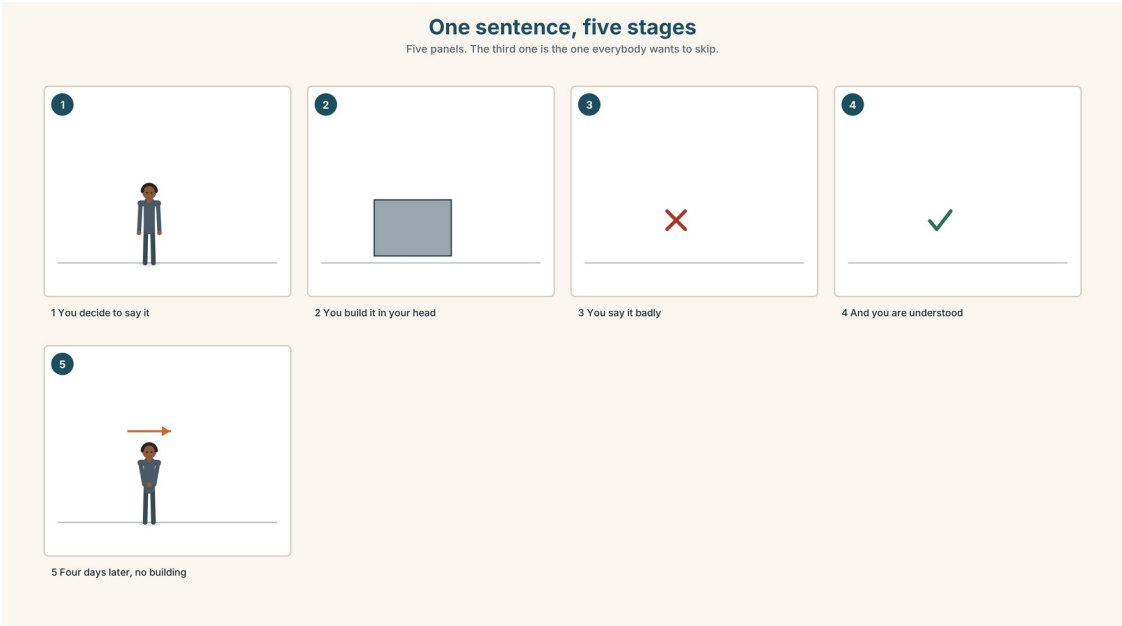
STUDY FILE • The work that is not on the timetable



6in}

The week that gets counted, and the week that does not — The lesson is the thin band. Everything thicker than it is invisible to everybody.

9A • Four hours, and the one that is visible



6in}

One sentence, five stages — Five panels. The third one is the one everybody wants to skip.

What is not counted

rehearsing a sentence on the stairs

What actually builds fluency

the rehearsal, every time

What it costs

nothing, and it is already happening

9B • Say it before you need it

The sentence you will need tomorrow can be built today, while you are walking. **Choose one sentence you will have to say this week. Build it now, out loud, three times.**

9C • Role play — the job you do not have

In pairs. One of you is doing a job you have never done. The other asks what you are doing. **Three minutes. Everything in the present continuous. Nobody may say *I don't know*.**

9D • The invisible hour

Find one hour in your week when your mind is free and your hands are busy. **That hour is where the rehearsal goes.** Name it.

9E • Transfer — before next week

Rehearse one English sentence out loud every day for seven days, before you need it. Bring the seven sentences and say which one you actually used.

Part 10 • Mediation & Interaction ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE



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One Saturday at the cafe — The busiest two hours are not the two hours with the most money in them.

10A • Relay

Half the class has the job description. Half has the nine things. **Rebuild the real job by speaking.** Ten minutes.

10B • Simplify — for one person

A new student asks: *What jobs can I do here with my English?* **Answer in four sentences.** Be honest and be useful.

10C • Online

Write **one message** to a classmate: say what you are doing right now and ask what they are doing. **Two sentences.**

10D • Your language

Does your language have a separate form for *right now*? **Say *I work* and *I am working* in your language.** Is it the same sentence?

Part 11 • The Decision ♦ C • THE PERFORMANCE

Saturday at the café

Marco's café is open eight hours on Saturday. He cannot do eight hours alone any more.

One person, eight hours. One wage, one person who learns the job properly, one person who is exhausted by two.

Two people, four hours each. Two wages for the same money, nobody exhausted, and twice as much training. The handover at twelve is twenty minutes of nobody serving anybody.

Nobody. He closes at two. He loses the afternoon, which is a third of Saturday's money and the only part he enjoys.

11A • The evidence

The counter at half past two
One person eight hours in, and the second of two people two hours in.

one person, hour eight

2 served · 3 waiting · 9 min wait · a dropped cup



two people, hour two

2 served · 0 waiting · 1 min wait · a clean floor



Find the six. One of them is on the floor behind the counter, and it is the one that costs money later.

6 differences — find them all

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6in}

The counter at half past two — One person eight hours in, and the second of two people two hours in.

 **Track 8.6.** Marco, 20 seconds: "Eight hours is not the problem. Hour seven is the problem. In hour seven I am still working and I am not working well, and the customer can see it."

11B • Talk about it

In threes. Use the frame. Everybody says one.

I think Marco should _____, because _____.

Words you can use: *job · shift · customer · break · work · team · uniform*

11C • Decide

Write **two sentences**. Choose, and say why.

I think Marco should _____, because _____.

11D • Model decision

Two people, with the handover at eleven and not at twelve. The twenty minutes of nobody serving is the whole argument against two people, and it disappears if you move it to the quietest hour instead of the busiest one.

11E • The Reveal

What happened. Marco hired two people and moved the handover to eleven. The twenty minutes cost him almost nothing, because at eleven there are four customers and at twelve there are twenty-six.

Then something he did not expect: the two of them overlapped for twenty minutes every week, and they started telling each other things about the customers. By March they knew more about his regulars than he did.

One question. You do not have to answer it out loud.

Marco was buying hours. What did the twenty minutes of overlap turn out to be worth?

Part 12 • Landing ♦ all three lines

12A • Recycle — twelve items

1. She _____ (clean) the office at this moment.
2. He _____ (start) work at six every day.
3. They _____ (not work) today.
4. She's _____ nurse.
5. He's _____ engineer.
6. I _____ in a hospital. (*the phrase for where you spend your working hours*)
7. I need to take a _____ .
8. What _____ you _____ ? (*the question about a job*)
9. I'm on my _____ .
10. Somebody has to _____ the phone.
11. (*Unit 7*) I love _____ (cook).
12. (*Unit 6*) How _____ coffees do you make?

12B • Consolidate — one task, everything in it

Write six sentences about one person's working day. Four in the present simple, two in the present continuous, one job name with *a* or *an*, and one thing that is not in the job title.

12C • Can-do, with evidence

☐ I can say what somebody is doing now. **Evidence:** 4C, 8D ☐ I can choose between the two present tenses. **Evidence:** 3G, 6D ☐ I can name a job correctly with *a* or *an*. **Evidence:** 6B ☐ I can use the short forms of *be*. **Evidence:** 7C

12D • Replay

Record 0C again. **Listen to both.** What is different?

12E • Glossary — thirty-five words, as a map

THE PEOPLE · nurse · driver · waiter · cook · cleaner · engineer · manager · customer **THE PLACES** · office · factory · kitchen · hospital · school **THE WORDS AROUND IT** · job · team · uniform · shift **WHAT YOU SAY** · work in a... · start work · finish work · take a break · What do you do? · I'm on my break. **WITH A OR AN** · a doctor · an engineer · an artist · a nurse **WHAT PEOPLE DO** · answer the phone · serve customers · clean the floor · make coffee · fix a machine · look after · come in · go out

12F • Next

Unit 9 • How do you find your way?